

your Internet connection primarily for e-mail, there may be some things you can do to reduce the amount of time you have to be online. To begin with, type your e-mail offline in your mail client. That way, when you connect, all you have to do is send and receive messages without staying online for too long. If you use Web-based e-mail, login to your account and open up all the messages you want to read in new windows (hold down [Shift] as you click the link). Once they are all open, you can disconnect, read them all offline and type replies to them in Notepad. Then connect again, paste the reply to each message and send them.

If you download files and software from the Internet, you must install a good download manager such as Download Accelerator Plus (www.speedbit.com) or FlashGet (www.flashget.com). Download managers are much better than using your browser because these programs split up files into several parts while downloading. A single-stream download will never be able to efficiently utilise the available bandwidth, so the software downloads the file in multiple streams. Also, usually these software can reliably check if the same file is available elsewhere for download and will get the file from the fastest server available. If for some reason the download stops midway, the software can resume downloading from that point

instead of downloading the entire file all over again.

I have so many images, sound and video clips. Can I organise them so that I can find them easily?

What you need is a media organiser. You may already be using one of the best tools for organising media files—the Microsoft Office Clip Gallery! This tiny tool catalogues all kinds of media files, segregates them into categories and associates keywords and descriptions with them, which you can use for powerful searches. You can add your own images, sound and video clips to the gallery and tag them as you want. You



Clip Gallery organises media

don't necessarily have to run this catalogue from an Office application—it is an independent utility that can run on its own. If you have Office, you should be able to find it in C:\Program Files\Common Files\Microsoft Shared\Artgalry. Run Cag.exe from here to run the Clip Gallery.

There are also some cool tools available for download. Advanced File Organizer (www.softprime.com) is easy to use and it can catalogue files and folders in hierarchical categories. You can tag every file with your



own keywords and descriptions, making it very easy to search for them later.

There are so many mouth-watering recipes available online. Yet, I can't find the right one for an occasion.

Recipe Organizer (www.primasoft.com) is excellent for managing and organising all your recipes into several categories. Apart from the ingredients and preparation method, it also stores the preparation time, serving size, an image of the dish, etc. If you want, you can even define other information about the recipe that you want to save. The next time you have a Hawaiian party, you will be able to find the right recipes in a flash. If you are comfortable with Excel, you can set up a similar functionality in Excel. Enter different properties of the recipes in separate columns and you can use Excel's powerful Sort and Filter functions to quickly locate recipes of certain kinds.

How do I make greeting cards on my PC?

You can use Word to make greeting cards on your PC and it's fairly simple once you get the hang of it. Basically, you need to set up the page so that it prints like a card. Begin by setting the page margins to 1.78 cm and the orientation to landscape. Centre the paragraph alignment and draw a straight line down the middle, along the cursor. Keep the [Shift] key pressed to draw the straight vertical line. This will serve as your guide for placing other objects on the card. Now you can place text boxes, images, WordArt, etc. on the page to make up the contents. The only thing you need to be careful about is to not get too close to the borders—you would be printing on both sides of the paper and you wouldn't want anything bleeding over the fold. Once you've created the inside of the card, create a copy of the page and make the outside.

The front

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